

[Return to Order of Business](#)

TAB 16



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-292-25/26, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 3/10/2026**In Control:** Family and Community Engagement Committee

Approval of Community Advisory Committee Members to Fill Mid-Year Vacancies

Office of Student, Family, and Community Engagement

Brief Description:

(Approval of Community Advisory Committee Members to Fill Mid-Year Vacancies) Recommends approval of prospective members of the Community Advisory Committee (CAC) that need to be appointed by the LAUSD Board of Education annually, per the California Education Code, section 56191.

Action Proposed:

Approve those persons included in Attachment A to complete the terms of membership left vacant on the CAC:

- 2 representatives to complete a 2024-2026 term left vacant,
- 1 representative to complete a 2025-2027 term left vacant, and
- 3 alternates to serve on the CAC for the remainder of the 2025-2026 school year.

Background:

The CAC serves in an advisory capacity to the Board of Education and the Division of Special Education on the Special Education Local Plan Area (SELPA) Local Plan.

The California Education Code, Section 56190-561931, requires each SELPA to establish a CAC to fulfill specific responsibilities. In addition, it requires that the members of the CAC be appointed by the Board of Education using selection procedures described in the SELPA Local Plan. CAC members serve a two-year term, which is staggered to ensure that no more than one half of the membership serves the first year of the term in any one year.

The CAC must be composed of the following: parents of individuals with exceptional needs enrolled in public or private schools (must serve as committee majority), parents of other students enrolled in school, students and adults with disabilities, regular education teachers, special education teachers, and other school personnel, representatives of other public and private agencies, and people concerned with the needs of individuals with exceptional needs. CAC bylaws also state that "CAC members must live, work, attend, or be the parent/guardian of a student attending a school within the LAUSD SELPA."

For the last decade, prospective members of the CAC were identified through the ranking of applications, with an appointment committee assigning points to applications based on a rubric. At parents' request last year for a more transparent process, the SELPA Local Plan language changed to allow for membership elections to occur in much the same way they transpire for other state-mandated District central committees identified in the California Education Code. On June 3, 2025, the Board of Education approved members of the CAC who were elected by peers for the 2025-2026 school year, as described in Rep-376-24/25.

The CAC has had six business meetings this school year, and absences have generated six vacancies for which peer elections were held mid-year: two positions in Region North (1 representative and 1 alternate) in the

category of parent of student with exceptional needs; two positions in the Virtual Academy (1 representative and 1 alternate) in the category of parent of student with exceptional needs; and two District-wide positions (1 representative and 1 alternate) in the category of parent of student in the general education program. To fill these mid-year vacancies, elections were held in a hybrid format, on-line via Zoom and with in-person technology support available at a central location for parents who may need access to a device or to the internet. In-person technology support was provided at Alta California Elementary School for the Region North election; and in-person technology support was provided at the Office of Student, Family, and Community Engagement for the Virtual Academy and for the District-wide elections.

Vacancies for membership on the CAC were advertised on District websites; through special education parent trainings and bi-weekly Family Academy webinars; through Region special education staff; and with email and text messages sent to over 2,900 School Site Council and English Learner Advisory Committee parent members and additionally to over 20,000 parents or guardians of students with exceptional needs. Membership vacancies were also advertised via flyers and announcements during CAC, PAC, and DELAC meetings; at Region Ambassador sessions and various Region workshops; through three information sessions for school Community Representatives; and sent directly to each Board of Education staff via email for distribution. The Division of Special Education and the Office of Student, Family, and Community Engagement held one election in December and two in January. The proposed persons being submitted for appointment to the CAC were elected by their peers, as required by the California Education Code.

According to the California Education Code, Section 56194, the CAC addresses the responsibilities defined in the local plan as described below, including, but not limited to, all the following:

- a. Advising the policy and administrative entity of the special education local plan area regarding the development, amendment, and review of the local plan. The entity shall review and consider comments from the community advisory committee.
- b. Recommending annual priorities to be addressed by the plan.
- c. Assisting in parent education and in recruiting parents and other volunteers who may contribute to the implementation of the plan.
- d. Encouraging community involvement in the development and review of the local plan.
- e. Supporting activities on behalf of individuals with exceptional needs.
- f. Assisting in parent awareness of the importance of regular school attendance.
- g. Supporting community involvement in the parent advisory committee established pursuant to Section 52063 to encourage the inclusion of parents of individuals with exceptional needs to the extent these pupils also fall within one or more of the definitions in Section 42238.01.

The Office of Student, Family and Community Engagement and the Division of Special Education are requesting a motion by the Los Angeles Unified School District Board of Education to appoint these newly elected members to the CAC.

The individuals in Attachment A were elected by their peers at a virtual election with the option to attend a central location for in-person technology support. They are recommended to be new representatives of the CAC to complete 2024-2026 or 2025-2027 terms left vacant, or as alternates for the remainder of the 2025-2026 school year.

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Expected Outcomes:

Approval by the Board of Education of those persons whose names have been submitted for CAC membership will enable the CAC to remain compliant within the guidelines established in the California Education Code, Sections 56190-56194.

Board Options and Consequences:

Approving the requested membership will enable the CAC to continue fulfilling the responsibilities as defined in the California Education Code, Section 56194, and in the SELPA Local Plan for service. If not approved, the District will be out of compliance with state requirements, and sanctions may be issued.

Policy Implications:

This action supports the Board's initiative to enhance parent engagement and is aligned to the Strategic Plan Pillar 3: Engagement and Collaboration. There are no changes to the existing policies of the District through this action.

Budget Impact:

None

Student Impact:

None

Equity Impact:

None

Issues and Analysis:

California Education Code, Sections 56190-56194, sets forth state requirements for the selection and appointment of members for the CAC. When elected members are no longer able to serve on the committee during the course of a school year, vacancies need to be filled in order to ensure there is representation as required by the law.

Attachments:

Attachment A - List of Mid-Year 2025-26 Community/Elected Advisory Committee Members

Submitted:

02/12/26

File #: Rep-292-25/26, Version: 1

Agenda Date: 3/10/2026

In Control: Family and Community Engagement Committee

RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,



ANDRES E. CHAIT
Acting Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



JANA CARTER
Chief of Communication, Engagement & Collaboration
Communication, Engagement & Collaboration

REVIEWED BY:



DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



ANTONIO PLASCENCIA
Sr. Director of Engagement & Partnerships
Communication, Engagement & Collaboration

REVIEWED BY:



KURT E. JOHN
Deputy Chief Financial Officer

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

ATTACHMENT A

**APPROVAL OF COMMUNITY ADVISORY COMMITTEE (CAC) MEMBERS
ELECTED MID-YEAR 2025-2026**

The following individuals have expressed interest and are eligible to serve on the CAC. Staff proposes that the Los Angeles Unified Board of Education approve the following candidates:

Name	Completing a Term Left Vacant for	Category	Region	Board District	Network
1. Perla Zacarias	2024-2026	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	3	Van Nuys/ Valley Glen
2. Andrea Prado	2025-2027	Parent of Student with Special Needs	Other (Virtual Academy)	4	N/A
3. Jennifer Noyes	2024-2026	Parent of a General Education Student	North	6	Sunland/ Tujunga

In addition, the following persons are being submitted as alternates to complete a 2025-2026 one-year term:

Name	Completing a Term Left Vacant for	Category	Region	Board District	Network
1. Andrea Urrutia	2025-2026	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	3	Reseda
2. Martha Acosta	2025-2026	Parent of a General Education Student	East	5	South Gate
3. Heidi Ramos	2025-2026	Parent of Student with Special Needs	Other (Virtual Academy)	7	N/A

ATTACHMENT A
APPROVAL OF COMMUNITY ADVISORY COMMITTEE (CAC) MEMBERS
ELECTED MID-YEAR 2025-2026

The Board approved the following members as representatives on June 3, 2025, who will continue to serve for the remainder of the 2025-2027 term:

Name	Category	Region	Board District	Network
1. Shalene Wright	Parent of Student with Special Needs	West	1	Hamilton
2. Kady Bynum	Student with Special Needs	North	3	Cleveland
3. Andrew Krowne	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	3	North Hollywood/ Valley Village
4. Monica Arrazola	Parent of Student with Special Needs	West	4	Hollywood
5. Silva-Marna Echavarria	Parent of Student with Special Needs	Virtual Academy	4	N/A
6. Maria Duran	Parent of Student with Special Needs	East	5	South Los Angeles
7. Isaiah Macedo-Ortiz	Student with Special Needs	East	5	South Gate
8. Bedia Valencia	Parent of Student with Special Needs	East	5	South Gate
9. Kristie Lacy	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	6	North Hollywood/ Valley Village
10. Jeanette Ramirez	Parent of Student with Special Needs	South	7	Rivera
11. Ana Carrion	Community-based Organization	Districtwide		
12. Alejandra Pina	Community Member	Districtwide		
13. Michelle Cherner	Special Education Teacher	Districtwide		
14. Rocio Elorza	Adult with Disability	Districtwide		

ATTACHMENT A
APPROVAL OF COMMUNITY ADVISORY COMMITTEE (CAC) MEMBERS
ELECTED MID-YEAR 2025-2026

The following persons will continue to serve for the remainder of the 2024-2026 term:

Name	Category	Region	Board District	Network
1. Juan Jose Mangandi	Parent of a General Education Student	South	1	Manual Arts / Vermont Square
2. Gabriela Rangel	Parent of Student with Special Needs	South	1	South Mid-City
3. Meeka Smith	Parent of Student with Special Needs	West	1	Hollywood / Fairfax
4. Janea Garcia	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	3	Taft
5. Yukiko Miyauchi	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	3	Van Nuys / Valley Glen
6. Rachel Millman	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	3	North Hollywood / Valley Village
7. Olivia Hobson	Parent of Student with Special Needs	Virtual Academy	4	N/A
8. Juliet Schwarz	Parent of Student with Special Needs	North	4	Taft
9. Denissa Zapata	Parent of Student with Special Needs	West	4	Hollywood / L.A. Mid-City
10. Norma Gonzalez	Parent of Student with Special Needs	East	5	South Gate
11. Mandi Mendez	Parent of Student with Special Needs	East	5	Bell / Cudahy / Maywood
12. Mark Halushka	Parent of Student with Special Needs	South	7	Carson
13. Jahuanna Roberson	Parent of Student with Special Needs	South	7	Fremont
14. Yoriko Hongo	General Education Teacher	Districtwide		
15. Sara Lucas	Administrator/Other School Staff	Districtwide		

ATTACHMENT A

APPROVAL OF COMMUNITY ADVISORY COMMITTEE (CAC) MEMBERS
ELECTED MID-YEAR 2025-2026

The Board approved the following persons as alternates on June 3, 2025, who will continue to serve for the remainder of the 2025-2026 term:

Name	Category	Region	Board District	Network
1. Ester Cruz	Student with Special Needs	West	5	Koreatown
2. Crystal Smith	Community Member	Districtwide		
3. Maria Luisa Palma	Community-based Organization	Districtwide		